

Android is No.1

Wall Street Journal conducted a poll for the best mobile OS; with 6365 votes registered, Android scored a hefty 50.7% still on orbit

India is the cheapest

A recent report from OTI shows that India has one of the cheapest cell phone plans in the world! Indians pay an average of \$12.90 per month in comparison to Canadians who pay a whopping \$67.50

repair facilities took less time to fix problems. Canon edges out Sony by 2.3 per cent, and Nikon trails by almost 50 per cent of the votes.

- 7) On an average, Canon users are the most loyal, and tend to recommend the brand to others.
- 8) People also feel that Canon cameras are cheaper to maintain.
- 9) Sony sneaks ahead in terms of overall credibility and satisfaction. We feel Sony's wider portfolio of products might have something to do with this, although we can't be 100 per cent sure.
- 10) The biggest jumper this year is Samsung. We feel this newfound popularity is in part due to a slew of new models launched in 2010.

The most trusted

Finally, we have a change at the top. Sony topples Canon's lead, and surpasses it as the most trusted brand. Although the difference is minimal and involves a change of only three points from last year, this is a big plus for Sony. While Canon jumped up two points from last year, Sony jumped five points. Nikon also rose, but by a single point and remains at number three.

FLASH STORAGE

If we could think of one aspect of computing technology that has grown by leaps and bounds, it has to be flash storage. Sure, today you can buy a 2 terabyte hard drive, but hard drive technology has hardly evolved in the last three years. Its younger sibling flash however, is evolving by leaps and bounds. Needless to say, flash will probably be the future of storage – it's compact, dissipates less heat, has no moving parts and is thus rugged. There are caveats too, but these seem to be on the mend.

Whether it be inside your digital camera, or as an SSD inside your notebook, or even a USB drive, chances are flash has already touched your life. We expect to see a lot more of it in the future. Last year, our survey was for external devices. This year, we've featured dedicated sections to flash and hard drive, as both technologies differ sufficiently in technology, price and usage scenarios to warrant this distinction.

Market watch

SSDs have emerged in the Indian market, available for the taking. Granted, the pricing is atrocious, and often inordinately higher than US prices, but this is the premium one pays for being an early adopter. However, on the whole flash is cheaper than it used to be, and with a 32 GB pen drive costing merely ₹4,000, pocket storage is getting better. Currently, 64 and 128 GB USB drives are very costly, but we hope to see prices slowly drop as people slowly start purchasing 32 GB drives.

Flash is also used in cameras, and with HD video recording coming in, we've seen an increase in the density of flash modules used. 8 GB is pretty much the norm these days, while 16GB and 32 GB cards have also become cheaper.

Important results

- 1) Kingston takes the lead when it comes to quality, with Transcend and SanDisk trailing close behind. Surprisingly, Corsair lost out big time. In fact, even HP, who is not a big player in the flash market took the lead over Corsair. Evidently, people associate Western Digital with "storage", whether Flash or hard drive, and a lot of people mentioned it.
- 2) A-Data is one of the larger players in the flash arena globally. However, they garner a very low trust level in

India. They've only just entered the Indian market this year, so perhaps this will change next year.

- 3) When it comes to innovation, the scales tip in Transcend's favour. Kingston loses out even to SanDisk, and is at third spot here. Interestingly, HP occupies the fourth spot, while Corsair languishes some 30 per cent behind.
- 4) Most people feel Kingston flash products are technologically advanced, and also stylish. This could be on account of the compact drives and the larger metal-body AES drives that Kingston produces. Transcend and SanDisk occupy the second and third spot, while HP is a close fourth.
- 5) Consumer satisfaction is an all-important element. How satisfied are you with your flash-based product? Transcend owners love the quality of theirs, but they feel that Kingston drives are slightly more plentiful in the market. Their thoughts mirror ours.
- 6) Kingston offers the best after sales support, according to our readers. They also resolve queries quicker, apparently.
- 7) 56 per cent of people who've bought Kingston say that they'd surely buy another product (other than flash) from the same brand – a winning score. 69.8 per cent of them say they'd buy another flash drive from King-

